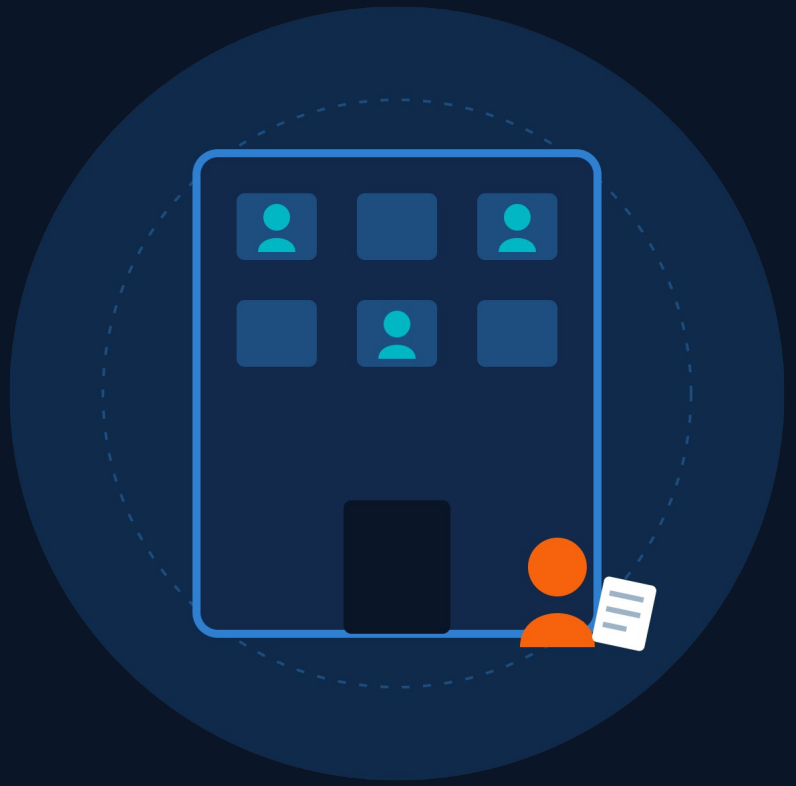
ZNEXORA TECH | SECURITY AWARENESS

# Insider Threats

## When the Risk Is Already Inside

Careless mistakes, disgruntled staff and how to protect sensitive data



Presented by: **ZNexora Tech** · [Presenter] · [Date]

01 · THE DEFINITION

# What is an insider threat?

**Anyone with legitimate access who harms our data or systems, on purpose or by accident.**

### Employees

Full-time and part-time staff

**Contractors and temps**

With temporary access

**Partners and suppliers**

Connected to our systems

### Former staff

If access isn't removed

Because insiders already have access, firewalls and antivirus often **can't tell the difference** between normal work and harm.

# Most insider incidents are mistakes

## SHARE OF INSIDER INCIDENTS




### 53%

### Careless

Honest mistakes: wrong recipient, lost laptop, risky sharing

### 27%

### Malicious

Deliberate harm: data theft, fraud, sabotage

### 20%

### Compromised

Account hijacked by an outsider through stolen credentials

Source: Ponemon Institute and DTEX, 2026 Cost of Insider Risks Global Report

# Everyday mistakes that leak data

### Wrong recipient
Email autocomplete sends data to the wrong person

### “Anyone with the link”
Files shared far more widely than intended

### Personal cloud or email
Work files sent home to “finish later”

### Pasting into AI tools
Confidential data put into public chatbots

### Lost devices
Unencrypted laptops, phones or USB drives

### Printouts and screens
Documents left on printers or desks

None of these people meant harm. **All of them caused a data breach.**

# When someone means harm

## COMMON MOTIVES

**Money**
Selling data or access to criminals or competitors

**Grievance**
Revenge after a conflict, demotion or dismissal

**Ideology or pressure**
Personal beliefs, or coercion by outsiders

## WHAT THEY DO

- Copying client lists before leaving for a competitor
- Deleting or sabotaging systems or data
- Committing fraud using their access
- Selling login details to ransomware groups

The most common moment: **the weeks before someone leaves.**

# Watch behaviours, not people

### Unusual downloads
Bulk copying or large exports

### Access outside their role
Browsing data they don't need

### Odd working hours
Late-night access with no reason

### Personal storage use
USB drives, personal email or cloud

### Bypassing controls
Disabling security or asking for exceptions

### Open grievances plus exit
Strong resentment and plans to leave

Concerned? **Report it confidentially.** Don't investigate or confront anyone yourself.

# Insider incidents are expensive

**$19.5M**

average annual cost of insider risk per organisation, up 20% in two years

**67 days**

average time to contain an insider incident

**$7.7M**

less when contained within 30 days ($14.2M) than after 90 days ($21.9M)

The faster an incident is reported, **the less it costs.**

Source: Ponemon Institute and DTEX, 2026 Cost of Insider Risks Global Report

# Not all data is equal

| LEVEL | WHO CAN SEE IT | EXAMPLES |
|---|---|---|
| **Public** | Approved for anyone | Website, press releases |
| **Internal** | For staff only | Policies, internal news |
| **Confidential** | Limited to those who need it | Customer data, contracts, finance |
| **Restricted** | Strictly controlled | Passwords, health data, legal matters |

The higher the level, the more care it needs. **Not sure? Treat it as Confidential.**

# Six habits that protect sensitive data

### Double-check recipients

Before sending anything sensitive

### Share with named people

Never “anyone with the link”

### Use approved storage only

No personal email, cloud, USB or AI tools

### Lock screen, clear desk

Every time you step away

### Access only what you need

And give back what you don't

### Report mistakes at once

No blame for honest mistakes

# Layered protection against insider risk

**Least privilege**
Access matched to each role

**Regular access reviews**
Remove access people no longer need

**Clean offboarding**
All access removed on the last day

**Data loss prevention**
Blocks risky sharing and uploads

**Behaviour analytics**
Flags unusual data access

**Speak-up culture**
Confidential reporting and support

Identity management and behaviour analytics delivered the largest cost savings in the 2026 Ponemon study.

Source: Ponemon Institute and DTEX, 2026 Cost of Insider Risks Global Report

# Made a mistake or seen something?

## I made a mistake

Sent data to the wrong person, lost a device or shared too widely.

**Tell IT immediately on [contact]. No blame for honest mistakes.**

## I've seen something

Unusual behaviour or data handling that worries you.

**Report confidentially to [security / HR contact]. Don't investigate yourself.**

QUESTIONS AND DISCUSSION

# Security starts with the people inside.

Handle data with care. Report mistakes fast. Speak up.

Thank you · Presented by ZNexora Tech

